



LEANDER, TEXAS

Relocation **Guide**

For Buyers · Prepared by Sarah Lechner · Magnolia Realty

Why Leander?

Leander, Texas has transformed from a quiet bedroom community into one of the most sought-after destinations in the Austin metro — and for good reason. With exceptional schools, master-planned communities, and a small-town spirit that somehow coexists with big-city proximity, Leander offers something rare: a place where families genuinely thrive. Whether you're relocating from across the country or simply moving up in the Austin market, this guide is designed to make your transition as smooth as possible.

"Moving to Leander means trading traffic and congestion for front-porch evenings, top-ranked schools, and a neighborhood that actually feels like a neighborhood. I've helped dozens of families make this move — and I've never once seen them look back."

Population 83,000+ · #37 Fastest-Growing U.S. City · ~\$451K Median Price · 30 min to Austin

At a Glance

- Located in Williamson County — lower property taxes than Travis County
- Home to Leander ISD, consistently rated among Texas's best school districts
- Rapid growth fueled by proximity to Apple, Dell, Oracle, and Tesla campuses
- Capital Metro Rail (MetroRail) connects directly to downtown Austin
- Parks, trails, Lake Travis access, and Hill Country scenery minutes away
- Master-planned communities with resort-style amenities throughout the city

Sources: U.S. Census Bureau; Niche.com; Williamson County Appraisal District; leanderisd.org

Leander ISD: Raising the Bar

Leander ISD holds an 88/100 score from the Texas Education Agency (2024–25) - one of the highest-performing districts in the Austin metro. With a 97% graduation rate, an average SAT score of 1,250, and 42,593 students enrolled across 43 campuses, LISD consistently produces graduates ready for top universities and competitive careers.

ISD RESOURCES

School Ratings (Texas Education Agency): leanderisd.org/assessmentaccountability

Find your school by address - Attendance Zoning: leanderisd.org/attendancezones

School	Level	Highlight
Rouse High School	High School (9–12)	Strong AP & dual credit programs
Glenn High School	High School (9–12)	Athletics, fine arts, STEM
Leander High School	High School (9–12)	One of Texas's larger high schools
Running Brushy Middle	Middle School	Science & technology focus
Rutledge Elementary	Elementary (K–5)	4.13/5 on Niche
Deer Creek Elementary	Elementary (K–5)	4.0/5 on GreatSchools

Beyond High School

Leander’s proximity to Austin puts students within reach of the University of Texas at Austin, Texas State University, and St. Edward’s University - all within 45 miles. Austin Community College serves the area with dual enrollment opportunities starting in high school.

1 Texas Education Agency, 2024–25 Accountability Ratings. leanderisd.org/assessmentaccountability

Find Your Community

Leander's neighborhoods range from established golf-course estates to brand-new master-planned communities — each with its own character. Here's a closer look at some of the most popular areas.

Crystal Falls

From \$660K · Established golf community, Hill Country views

One of Leander's most established communities, Crystal Falls surrounds the Crystal Falls Golf Club with winding roads, mature trees, and panoramic Hill Country views. Custom and semi-custom homes feature generous lots and architectural detail. The community's pools, parks, and trail system create a resort-like atmosphere year-round.



Travisso

From \$750K+ · Luxury new construction, resort amenities

Travisso is Leander's premier luxury master-planned community, set against dramatic limestone bluffs with sweeping views of Lake Travis and the Hill Country. The community clubhouse, resort pool, tennis courts, and miles of trails rival five-star resort amenities. Builders like Taylor Morrison and Drees offer customizable plans from the high \$600s into the millions.



Find Your Community

Bryson

\$380K – \$500K · New construction, lakeside amenity center

Bryson is one of Leander's fastest-growing communities, built around a stunning 17-acre lake with a boat dock, resort pool, splash pad, and event lawn. With attainable price points and modern floor plans, Bryson attracts young families looking for community and lifestyle. Multiple builders — including Tri Pointe and Pulte — offer a range of home styles.



Block House Creek

\$300K – \$465K · Established, no HOA, large lots

Block House Creek offers something rare in the Austin metro: established homes with large lots, mature trees, and no HOA — at attainable price points. Parks, pool, and tennis courts are maintained by the voluntary BHCHIA. An excellent choice for buyers seeking space and value.



More neighborhoods: Grand Mesa at Crystal Falls (\$1.165M) · Highlands at Crystal Falls (\$647.5K) · Carneros Ranch (\$644K) · Cold Springs (\$544.5K) · Mason Hills (\$519.9K) · Vista Ridge (\$429.3K) · Lakeline Ranch (\$462K) · Westwood (\$355K) · Leander Heights (\$365K)

What Buyers Need to Know

Leander's median sale price reached \$451,000 in early 2026, representing a 6.9% year-over-year increase — a strong signal of continued demand even as broader Texas markets stabilized. Homes average 2,562 square feet at \$202 per square foot, offering compelling value compared to Austin proper, where comparable square footage routinely exceeds \$350/sq ft. New construction remains active with multiple master-planned communities delivering inventory, giving buyers both resale and new-build options across all price points.

"The best time to buy in Leander was five years ago. The second best time is now — before the next wave of corporate relocations to the Austin corridor locks prices into a new plateau."

Neighborhood Median Prices

NEIGHBORHOOD	MEDIAN / PRICE RANGE
Grand Mesa at Crystal Falls	\$1,165,000
Travisso	\$750,000+
Highlands at Crystal Falls	\$647,500
Crystal Falls	\$660,000
Carneros Ranch	\$644,000
Cold Springs	\$544,500
Mason Hills	\$519,900
Lakeline Ranch	\$462,000
Vista Ridge	\$429,300
Bryson	\$380,000 – \$500,000
Block House Creek	\$300,000 – \$465,000
Leander Heights	\$365,000
Westwood	\$355,000

Source: Williamson County Appraisal District; MLS data February 2026. Prices reflect recent sales and should be verified with current listings.

Family Picks

\$500,000 – \$650,000

The next four pages zoom in on the communities I recommend most often to relocating families shopping between \$500K and \$650K. Every one is zoned to Leander ISD, built in the 2000s or later, and offers the space, schools, and amenities growing families ask for. Price ranges in this section reflect homes within this budget, so they may differ from the full-market ranges shown earlier in the guide.

Bryson

Master-planned, active community

Crystal Falls

Established, Hill Country feel

Travisso

Upscale, resort-style amenities

Parkside at Mayfield Ranch

Newer homes, Leander ISD schools

Find Your Community

Every community in this guide is zoned to Leander ISD, built primarily in the 2000s or later, and priced within the \$500,000–\$650,000 range. Each has its own personality - here's a closer look.

Bryson

\$500K – \$640K · mybrysoncommunity.com · Master-planned, active community

Bryson is a newer, master-planned neighborhood with a strong sense of community. Think parks, trails, a resort-style pool, and neighborhood events - perfect for families who want a connected, active lifestyle. Kids can ride bikes to the amenity center; neighbors know each other by name.



SHOPPING & DINING NEARBY

HEB grocery under 5 minutes · Northline District (Leander's new walkable retail hub) nearby · Cedar Park Town Center with Target, Best Buy, and 30+ restaurants under 10 minutes away.

CURRENT LISTINGS - BRYSON

- › [1108 Sweetspire St, Leander TX 78641](#)
- › [1917 Woolsey Way, Leander TX 78641](#)
- › [924 Hornsby Hollow, Leander TX 78641](#)

Find Your Community

Crystal Falls

\$520K – \$650K · crystalfallshoa.com · Established, Hill Country feel

A beautiful, established community with a true Hill Country feel. Known for top-rated Leander ISD schools, mature trees, and great amenities, Crystal Falls is a favorite for families wanting space, scenery, and convenience. The golf course, pools, parks, and trail system create a resort-like atmosphere year-round.



CURRENT LISTINGS - CRYSTAL FALLS

- › [2304 Arroyo Grande, Leander TX 78641](#)
- › [2813 Granite Hill Cove, Leander TX 78641](#)
- › [2852 Coral Valley Dr, Leander TX 78641](#)

Travisso

\$580K – \$650K+ · travisso.com · Upscale resort-style, limited availability in range

Upscale living with stunning Hill Country views and resort-style amenities. Travisso is one of Leander's more luxury communities, offering larger homes, hilltop scenery, and a quieter, elevated feel. Homes at the lower end of the price range do come available - and new build inventory is worth watching.



NEW BUILDS

[Browse Travisso new build inventory →](#)

CURRENT LISTINGS - TRAVISSO

- › [1329 Marina Grand Ter, Leander TX 78641](#)
- › [1228 Siena Sunset Rd, Leander TX 78641](#)
- › [4513 Lucabella Ln, Leander TX 78641](#)

Find Your Community

Parkside at Mayfield Ranch

\$500K – \$620K · Georgetown address, Leander ISD schools · [Community Overview](#)

Don't let the Georgetown mailing address fool you - Parkside at Mayfield Ranch is zoned to highly sought-after Leander ISD schools, which is what matters most for families. You get newer homes (2010s–2020s builds), a peaceful and beautifully maintained setting, and strong value for your dollar - all while feeding into the same great schools as Leander proper.

Shopping is excellent here: Wolf Ranch Town Center (Georgetown's newest retail hub with HEB, Target, and a full lineup of restaurants) is just 5 minutes away. The 183A on-ramp puts North Austin within 30 minutes.



CURRENT LISTINGS - PARKSIDE AT MAYFIELD RANCH

- › [144 Copper Lake Ln, Georgetown TX 78628](#)
- › [705 Garner Park Dr, Georgetown TX 78628](#)
- › [112 Bastrop Dr, Georgetown TX 78628](#)

Commute & Transportation

Leander’s 183A Toll Road is your direct, low-stress corridor into North Austin. Most residents reach the Domain or major tech campuses in 25–35 minutes - a refreshing contrast to the gridlock many relocating families leave behind.

RAIL - CAPITAL METRO METRORAIL	CAR - MAJOR CORRIDORS
Leander → Downtown Austin: ~45 min	183A Toll → The Domain: ~25 min
Leander → Lakeline Station: ~12 min	183A Toll → Apple Campus: ~30 min
Free parking at Leander Station	183A Toll → Downtown Austin: ~40 min
Weekday service from 5:30 AM	SH-45 connects to SH-130 (Tesla, Samsung)
Bike-share & bus connections at stops	SH-29 westward to Georgetown

NORTHLINE: Leander’s Coming Shopping & Dining Hub

“The Northline development - a 116-acre mixed-use project anchored by the Leander MetroRail station - will bring retail, restaurants, offices, and apartments directly connected to Austin’s rail network. Think a neighborhood-scale version of the Domain, right in the heart of Leander. Expected to open in phases beginning 2026.”

[Learn more about the Northline District →](#)

Source: Capital Metro 2025 Service Guide; City of Leander Northline Development Plan.

Dining, Shopping & Outdoor Life

Leander's lifestyle scene has grown alongside its population. Whether you're looking for a family dinner spot, weekend coffee, or a food truck evening with the kids, you'll find it all here - with more opening every season.

Family-Friendly Dining

Hopdoddy Burger Bar

Specialty burgers, hand-spun milkshakes, and fries the whole family will love. Coming to Leander at Ronald Reagan Blvd.

Hat Creek Burger Company

Austin's beloved outdoor burger spot - playground, covered patio, and kid-friendly menu. A true local institution.

Torchy's Tacos

Damn good tacos and a festive vibe. A household name across Austin, now well represented in the Leander/Cedar Park area.

Chuy's Tex-Mex

Bold Tex-Mex flavors, Texas-size plates, and a fun atmosphere families have loved for decades. Multiple locations near Leander.

Local Coffee Shops

Instill Coffee Co.

Organic roasts, community-centric vibes, and cozy spaces - a Cedar Park favorite right on Whitestone Blvd.

Summer Moon Coffee

Austin's legendary oak-roasted coffee and signature Moon Milk®. Multiple area locations with a warm, welcoming atmosphere.

Casa Costa Bake Shop

A charming Portuguese-Brazilian bakery in a restored 1930s cottage in Old Town Leander. Pastries, strong coffee, and a neighborhood-gathering feel.

Food Trucks & Beer Gardens

The Good Lot

Cedar Park's family-friendly beer garden and food truck park - live music, yard games, a kids' playscape, rotating food trucks, and dogs welcome. A Saturday afternoon tradition for local families.

Shopping, Outdoors & Community

Shopping

183A Toll Road Corridor - H-E-B, Target, Costco, Home Depot, and more, right along your daily commute.

Wolf Ranch Town Center - Georgetown's newest retail hub: HEB, Target, dining row, 5 min from Parkside.

Lakeline Mall - Major anchor mall 10 minutes south in Cedar Park.

The Domain (20 min) - Upscale shopping, dining, and entertainment in North Austin.

Outdoors

Lake Travis - Boating, swimming, and waterside dining 25 minutes away.

Brushy Creek Regional Trail - Miles of paved trail for running and cycling.

Crystal Falls Golf Club - Semi-private 18-hole course within the community.

Leander City Parks - 10+ parks with playgrounds, sports fields, and pavilions.

Community & Culture

Leander punches above its weight culturally. The Leander Community Theater, seasonal farmers market, and annual Leander BBQ Cook-off foster the community connection that's increasingly hard to find in high-growth suburbs. The city's recreation center offers fitness classes, youth sports leagues, and senior programming - designed for families at every life stage.

COST OF LIVING

Your Dollar Goes Further Here

Texas has no state income tax - a significant financial advantage for families relocating from many other states. Leander's location in Williamson County means property tax rates typically 0.2–0.4% lower than comparable Travis County addresses. Combined with housing prices well below

comparable metro neighborhoods, the long-term financial case is compelling.

“When you factor in no state income tax, lower property taxes, and housing that’s a fraction of what you’d pay in comparable metros, the financial case for Leander is impossible to ignore – especially for families relocating from high-tax states.”

Category	Austin (Central)	Leander, TX
Median Home Price	\$650,000+	\$500K–\$650K - newer builds
Property Tax Rate	~2.3–2.5%	~2.1% + NO state income tax
State Income Tax	None	None - Texas advantage
Avg Rent (2BR)	\$2,200–\$2,800	\$1,600–\$1,900
Commute Feel	Central congestion	183A Toll, 25–35 min, low stress
Home Size	Smaller city lots	Spacious yards, Hill Country views
School Quality	Varies by AISD campus	Leander ISD - TEA 88/100

Source: Williamson County Appraisal District; Numbeo Cost of Living Index 2025; Texas Comptroller property tax data.

Your Step-by-Step Roadmap

Buying from out of state requires preparation and the right agent. Here's the process we follow to get relocating families into their home with confidence - no stress, no surprises.

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- 01 Get Pre-Approved**

Before touring homes, connect with a local lender to secure your pre-approval letter. In Leander's market, sellers expect buyers to come prepared - a strong pre-approval signals serious intent and accelerates every subsequent step.

 - 02 Define Your Priorities**

School zone, commute time, lot size, new vs. resale, community amenities - we help you rank must-haves vs. nice-to-haves so every showing is purposeful and efficient.

 - 03 Tour & Evaluate**

If you can visit Austin, we do a full neighborhood and home tour. If not, I do FaceTime walkthroughs and send video tours of every home. Sarah's neighborhood knowledge means honest insights, not just a sales pitch.

 - 04 Craft a Winning Offer**

We use comprehensive MLS data to price your offer strategically, advising on earnest money, option periods, and contingencies to keep you competitive without unnecessary risk.

 - 05 Inspection & Option Period**

Texas contracts include a standard option period for inspections. Our trusted network of inspectors and contractors ensures that if issues arise, we move quickly on renegotiations.

 - 06 Close & Move In**

We coordinate with the title company, lender, and seller's agent through every final step. Sarah doesn't consider the job done until the keys are in your hand - and she'll have a list of her favorite local spots ready for you.
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Seasonal Tip: Spring (March-May) brings the highest inventory and competition. Fall (September-November) often offers more negotiating room with motivated sellers.

A Team Built on Service

The Schauer Team at Magnolia Realty has earned a reputation as one of North Austin's most trusted real estate teams - through client-first service that generates referrals year after year.

Platinum Top 50 Realtors - Austin, TX (2023 & 2024) · Experience.com #1 for Client Reviews (2024) · Magnolia Realty North Austin - Top Team (2023 & 2024) · Most Families Served, N. Austin (2023 & 2024)

WHAT SARAH'S CLIENTS SAY

““

“Sarah has honestly been heaven sent. She made this experience so easy. The thought of moving from Illinois to Texas was not easy, but with Sarah’s help she eased my anxiety. From the bottom of my heart, we are so grateful to have met her.”

- DESIREE C. · LEANDER, TX · EXPERIENCE.COM

““

“She is the first realtor we’ve had who has truly gone above and beyond. She took the time to listen to our wants and needs. Once we were in our final few weeks of closing she was in constant contact and always willing to help us get bids from contractors.”

- NICKI L. · LEANDER, TX · GOOGLE

““

“Sarah made our home buying process stress free. Adding that we are relocating from another state makes it even more difficult – Sarah provided us that comfort knowing that from afar, we were in good hands.”

- JACKSON C. · LEANDER, TX · EXPERIENCE.COM

YOUR GUIDE

Meet Sarah Lechner

REALTOR® · Magnolia Realty · The Schauer Team · Licensed in Texas



Sarah Lechner brings a unique perspective to real estate: she's been the client. Having relocated her own family to the Austin area, Sarah understands firsthand the complexity - and the emotional weight - of moving across state lines. That experience informs every interaction she has with her clients.

As a mom of three boys, family amenities, school quality, and neighborhood safety aren't just talking points for Sarah - they're her everyday life. She specializes in relocation buyers, particularly families making the move from high-cost metros. She listens first, then acts - whether you're touring remotely or deciding under time pressure, she provides the clarity that out-of-state buyers especially need.

READY TO FIND YOUR PLACE IN LEANDER?

Sarah Lechner
REALTOR®

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Online sarahsellsatx.com
experience.com/reviews
schauerteamrealty.com

Sources: U.S. Census Bureau; Williamson County Appraisal District; Texas Education Agency (leanderisd.org); Niche.com; Capital Metro 2025; Numbeo 2025; MLS data early 2026. All prices approximate. For informational purposes only.